



MENSTRUAL PADS 101

How to Choose and Use Them

Menstrual pads, also called sanitary pads or sanitary napkins, are absorbent products used to manage menstrual bleeding. They attach to the inside of underwear and absorb blood during a period.

Unlike products such as tampons or menstrual cups, pads are external products and do not need to be inserted into the body. Because of this, they are often considered one of the simplest and most accessible period products.

How Menstrual Pads Work

A menstrual pad has an absorbent center that collects menstrual blood. The back of the pad contains a sticky strip that attaches to underwear to keep the pad in place.

Some pads also include wings, which fold around the sides of underwear to help prevent leaks and movement.

Pads should be placed in the underwear, not inserted into the vagina.

Choosing the Right Pad

Pads come in many varieties, including different absorbencies, materials, and shapes.

Absorbency

- Panty liners for very light flow or spotting
- Regular pads for moderate bleeding
- Super or overnight pads for heavier flow

Materials

- Synthetic materials
- Organic cotton
- Bamboo-based fabrics

Design

- Wings for extra protection
- Thin designs for comfort
- Longer or overnight shapes for heavier flow

Advantages and Possible Disadvantages

Advantages

- Easy to use
- Require no insertion
- Comfortable for beginners
- Make it easy to monitor flow
- Useful for light bleeding or spotting

Possible disadvantages

- Some may feel bulky
- May shift during intense activity
- Cannot be used while swimming

How to Use and Change a Pad

Using a pad is simple:

- Remove the pad from its wrapper
- Peel off the adhesive backing
- Press the sticky side onto the inside of underwear
- If the pad has wings, wrap them around the sides of the underwear

Pads should generally be changed every four to six hours, or sooner if they become soaked.

Changing pads regularly helps:

- Prevent leaks
- Maintain hygiene
- Reduce skin irritation

Key Takeaway

Menstrual pads are a simple, reliable, and widely used method of period management. With different absorbencies, materials, and shapes available, individuals can choose products that match their comfort level and menstrual flow.

The best menstrual product is the one that helps a person manage their period safely and confidently.

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

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